

Context and Purpose

- Internal strategy session on building the MoreHarvest agency brand from scratch
- Riaan walked through an 11-step design and positioning plan; Cal shared parallel market research
- Agreed to sync tomorrow to align on scope and avoid duplicating work

Market Positioning and Differentiation

- Taiwan not known for design quality or software; global standard is the benchmark
- Key differentiator: integrated design, engineering, and business understanding working together
 - JJ project as proof: client sees results in minutes, decisions made live
 - Delivered JJ at half the time and half the price vs. competitor quote (6 months, 1.6-1.8M NTD vs. 3 months)
- Core value proposition: don't mention AI directly; translate outcomes into time, money, manpower saved
- Anti-subscription positioning: build products clients own and control, staff trained to operate independently
 - "We make ourselves useless" after delivery, opposite of Adobe-style lock-in

The 11-Step Brand and Design Plan

- Step 1: Global competitor research, focusing on best international design and tech studios
 - Study why top brands are clear: storytelling, defined voice, consistent identity
- Step 2: Positioning MoreHarvest, finding the gap, defining what makes it different
- Step 3: Establish brand foundations: name, core idea, personality, headline, value proposition
 - Benchmark against top AI-first studios and independent creative houses (e.g. Sagmeister)
- Steps 4-5: Brand guidelines, then design guidelines (fonts, color, layout)
 - Logo comes after brand personality is set, not before
- Step 6: Brand voice definition
 - Identified as a recurring weakness at MoreHarvest: no rules, no banned words, no consistent tone
 - Needs: language standard (British vs. US), approved phrasing, banned terms
- Steps 7-8: Case studies using existing projects (JJ, GK, Map, Value Add)
 - MoreHarvest itself shows the traditional approach; other projects show the new integrated method
 - All case studies follow a single template, answering: why done, what was proven, how proven
 - Free case studies (e.g. clinic website) to build portfolio without revenue pressure; must be recorded
- Step 9: Design guidelines published as a Storybook (flexible for digital, print, consulting)
- Step 10: "Coming soon" site, text-only, leading with the client's pain point

- Draft framing: “You paid a lot, now it’s broken or subscription-locked. We build for you, train your staff, then leave.”
- Step 11: Go-to-market; first design cycle complete when coming soon page is live

Outbound and Lead Generation Strategy

- Automated workflow: use AI to research target companies, generate custom mockups from design guidelines, send in batch
 - Identify one clear weakness per prospect as the cold outreach hook (news scraping, public data)
 - Show the weakness upfront; if they respond, they’re a qualified lead; if not, naturally filtered out
- Target segments discussed:
 - Taiwan hardware/AI supply chain companies needing global expansion
 - Government and tourism sites with known failures (broken coupons, outdated UX, public scandals)
 - SMBs burned by past consultancies (Inkslap and JJ as reference cases)
- Outreach channels: LinkedIn, networking events, Pipedrive contacts
- Positioning hook: “We spotted this problem in your product. Here’s how we’d fix it.”

Alignment and Next Steps

- Risk of overlapping work between Riaan (brand/design/positioning) and Cal (market/business model)
 - Agreed: Riaan owns brand, design, and positioning; Cal owns market research and business model
 - Overlap acceptable during brainstorm phase; needs to narrow after
- Meeting notes to be saved to shared Drive, later connected to Float for persistent AI context
- Riaan to send the 11-step document to a shared group including Cal
- Book recommendation: “Becoming Steve Jobs” (closer, more personal account than the Isaacson biography)

Next Steps

- **Share the 11-step brand plan document with Cal and Henry (Riaan)**
 - Create a shared group channel and post the document so the team can divide ownership of each step.
- **Sync with Cal tomorrow to align on scope (Riaan)**
 - Review the 11 steps together, assign who does what, and avoid duplicating positioning work.
- **Cal to prepare something to show Henry by Wednesday 8th July (Cal)**
 - Cal flagged he wasn't ready today; committed to having material ready by Wednesday.
- **Save meeting notes to shared Drive (Riaan)**
 - Connect to Float later so AI has full context of discussions and decisions over time.

Chat with meeting transcript:

<https://notes.granola.ai/t/bffb03d2-00c3-4e8d-b3b1-e4c671c5157d>